Richard Vidzrakou

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Professional Summary

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AWS Cloud Engineer with 3 years of hands-on experience designing, deploying, and managing cloud infrastructure on AWS. Experienced with core AWS services, including EC2, S3, VPC, IAM, Lambda, API Gateway, Auto Scaling, CloudWatch, and AWS SAM. Strong understanding of cloud architecture, networking, security, and infrastructure best practices.
Backed by 3+ years of software engineering experience building modern web applications and backend services using Node.js, Laravel, React, and PostgreSQL. Experienced in deploying cloud-native applications, improving system reliability, and implementing scalable solutions that support business growth and operational efficiency.

Professional Experience

DevOps Intern (Team Lead)
Azubi Africa | Remote | May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Directed a multidisciplinary team in the execution of AWS cloud and DevOps project initiatives, utilizing Agile methodologies to coordinate project delivery.
- Architected and deployed cloud-native serverless architectures on AWS, integrating services such as Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3, CloudFront, and Amazon Bedrock.
- Streamlined resource provisioning by implementing Infrastructure as Code (IaC) with Terraform, enhancing environment scalability and deployment consistency.
- Partnered with cross-functional members to build AI-driven automation workflows and serverless applications aligned with technical specifications and milestones.

Software Developer (Freelance & Personal Projects)
Remote | 2022 – Present

- Delivered 20+ web applications and digital platforms for 7+ clients and organizations across education, real estate, fintech, and service industries, expanding digital access and online service delivery.
- Integrated Paystack payment gateways, Moodle LMS, booking workflows, and administrative dashboards to streamline transactions, learning management, and customer interactions.

- Deployed and maintained production-ready applications on VPS environments using Docker and Cloudflare, improving deployment consistency, system availability, and performance.
- Collaborated with clients and stakeholders to translate business requirements into scalable digital solutions that enhanced operational efficiency and user engagement.

Backend Developer
CropCapital Investment | Accra, Ghana | Oct 2025 – Present

- Architect and maintain backend services for an agricultural investment platform supporting secure investment transactions and business operations.
- Design and optimize REST APIs to improve data exchange between mobile and backend services and enhance application responsiveness.
- Implement security controls and performance enhancements to strengthen platform reliability and prepare the system for increased user adoption.
- Collaborate with frontend engineers and stakeholders to deliver features aligned with product objectives and business requirements.

Cloud Engineer Intern
AmaliTech | Remote |June 2025 – July 2025

- Provisioned and configured AWS resources, including EC2, S3, IAM, Lambda, and VPC, through hands-on cloud engineering labs and guided projects.
- Monitored cloud workloads using CloudWatch metrics and logs to support observability and incident analysis.
- Collaborated with a cohort of cloud engineering interns on practical exercises, improving technical communication, teamwork, and leadership skills.

IT Support & Web Developer
Doyen Institute of Intelligence and Investigation | Accra, Ghana | Oct 2024 – Aug 2025

- Engineered and maintained internal websites and digital platforms supporting investigative, administrative, and training operations across 3 departments.
- Administered IT infrastructure and provided technical support for 20+ employees, minimizing operational disruptions and ensuring business continuity.
- Digitized manual reporting and record management workflows involving 200+ case and operational records, reducing paperwork and improving information accessibility.
- Managed server configurations, user permissions, and access controls to strengthen data security and maintain uninterrupted system availability.
- Partnered with management teams to identify and implement technology-driven process improvements that enhanced operational efficiency.
- Resolved hardware, software, and network incidents, reducing downtime and improving staff productivity.

IT Support
Kaaseman Rural Bank | Sunyani, Ghana | Sept 2023 – Nov 2023

- Provided technical support and troubleshooting services across multiple departments to maintain uninterrupted banking operations.
- Configured workstations, printers, and network devices, ensuring reliable access to organizational systems.
- Installed software updates and performed routine system maintenance to improve system stability and security.
- Assisted in developing an internal load returns banking application using Python and Flask.
- Maintained IT asset inventory records and supported user onboarding by configuring user accounts and workstations.

Skills & Competencies

- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, API Gateway, VPC, IAM, CloudWatch, Auto Scaling, DynamoDB, CloudFront, AWS SAM, Amazon Bedrock), Docker, Kubernetes, Linux, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, VPS Hosting
- **Backend & Web Development:** Node.js, Express.js, Laravel, React.js, PostgreSQL, SQL, JavaScript, PHP, REST APIs
- **Infrastructure & Architecture:** Serverless Architecture, Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, AWS SAM), Cloud Deployment, Containerization, System Monitoring, High Availability Architecture
- **AI & Automation:** Prompt Engineering, Large Language Models (LLMs), ChatGPT, Claude, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Amazon Q Developer, AI Application Integration, Workflow Automation
- **Tools & Collaboration:** Git, GitHub, Trello, Notion, Slack, Microsoft Teams, Discord, Firebase, Supabase, WordPress, cPanel, hPanel, Moodle LMS Integration, Zoom API, Paystack Integration
- **Professional Competencies:** Agile Methodologies, Technical Documentation, Team Leadership, Cross-functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Engagement, System Troubleshooting, Debugging, Problem Solving, Prioritization, Continuous Learning

Project Experience

AI-Powered Serverless Student Support System
AWS Lambda, API Gateway, Amazon S3, DynamoDB, Amazon OpenSearch, Amazon Bedrock, Google Gemini | Azubi Africa

- Architected a serverless student assistance platform utilizing Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) to provide intelligent, context-driven academic support.

- Engineered robust APIs via AWS Lambda and API Gateway to facilitate seamless student inquiries and secure processing of document ingestion tasks.
- Deployed Amazon S3 for centralized document storage, DynamoDB for efficient metadata handling, and Amazon OpenSearch to enable advanced vector-based semantic searching.
- Leveraged Amazon Bedrock to produce high-quality, context-aware responses by integrating institutional data through embeddings and vector retrieval techniques.
- Developed an automated AI ingestion pipeline featuring intelligent classification and metadata extraction to optimize search precision and streamline administrative workflows.

Serverless Event Registration System
AWS Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, SNS, IAM, Terraform | Azubi Africa

- Designed and provisioned a serverless event registration platform using Terraform.
- Configured API Gateway to invoke Lambda functions for processing registration requests.
- Stored participant data in DynamoDB and automated email notifications through SNS.
- Implemented IAM roles and policies to enforce least-privilege access.
- Automated infrastructure deployment and management using Infrastructure as Code (Serverless Application Model, SAM).

Infrastructure Provisioning with Terraform
Terraform, AWS Lambda, API Gateway, S3, IAM | Azubi Africa

- Provisioned AWS infrastructure using Terraform modules and dependency management.
- Deployed a serverless application integrating API Gateway, Lambda, and S3.
- Configured IAM roles and permissions to support secure service interactions.
- Applied explicit and implicit dependencies to ensure predictable resource deployment.
- Reduced manual provisioning effort through repeatable Infrastructure as Code practices.

4-Tier Containerized Institutional Platform
React.js | Node.js | Docker | VPS | Paystack | CloudFlare | Doyen Institute

- Architected and deployed a four-tier institutional platform comprising a public website, API layer, administrative dashboard, and student portal using Docker and VPS hosting.
- Integrated Cloudflare DNS, caching, and security services to optimize content delivery, improve performance, and enhance site availability.
- Implemented Paystack payment processing to support secure online transactions and student service accessibility.
- Designed a decoupled architecture that simplified independent deployments, maintenance, and future scalability.
- Optimized site performance and infrastructure reliability, contributing to over 10,000 page views within the first month of launch.

Education

University of Energy and Natural Resources

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
2021 – 2024

Certifications

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, AWS - view link here
  November 21, 2025
- AWS Knowledge - Cloud Essentials, AWS - view link here
  May 24, 2026
- AWS Cloud Quest: Cloud Practitioner Training Badge, AWS - view link here
  March 13, 2026
- AgentCon Accra – Global AI Community - view link here